Poetry Magazine cover design
2025, Two cover explorations for Poetry magazine

Context
Inspired by Arun Kolatkar's poetry collection Jejuri, these two cover designs explore how poetry finds meaning in ordinary moments, objects and observations. The first draws from the physical and textured world of Jejuri, particularly its temple carvings, stone structures and sense of history. The second moves towards the quieter, more intimate moments in poems such as The Priest's Son and The Butterfly. Together, the covers explore two sides of Kolatkar's writing: the sacred and the everyday, the permanence of stone and the fleeting nature of life.

My role
Poetry research, visual interpretation, typography, illustration and cover design.

Process
For the first cover, I hand-drew engravings inspired by the Jejuri temple, incorporating them into the letters of the title POETRY. For the second, I explored a more minimal direction, taking inspiration from Poetry magazine's 2007 design era. I focused on typography, open space and muted colours to capture the stillness and delicate observations in Kolatkar's poems.

Outcome
Two distinct cover designs for a poetry magazine, each interpreting Kolatkar's writing through a different visual approach. It shows my ability to interpret literary themes and translate them into visual concepts using typography, illustration, composition and colour, while creating distinct visual approaches for the same piece of writing.

POETRY
DECEMBER 2025

POETRY

$6.95 USA
$9.95 CAD
£7.95 UK

DECEMBER 2007

POETRY

FEATURING
Arun Kolatkar



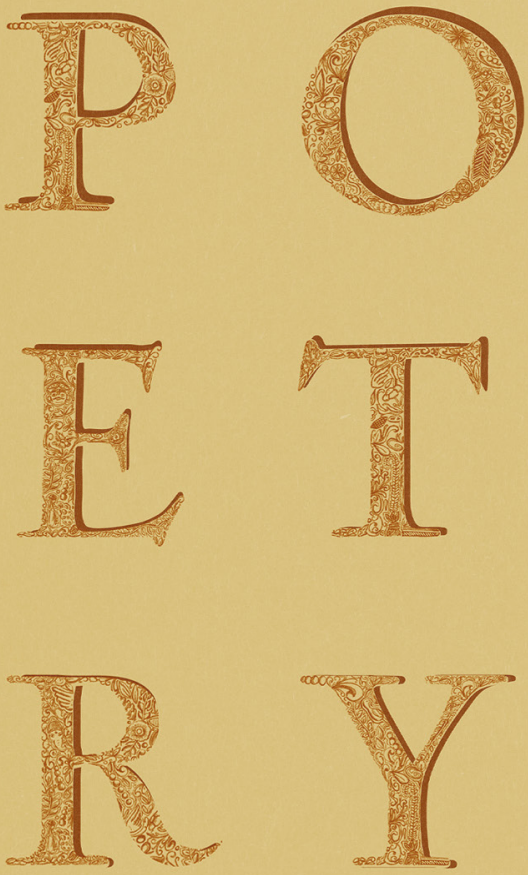
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